

BM2: Lesson 3 – Abram

No Heir, Wait Here

 **Theme:** Trusting God when the wait is long

 **Background Text:** Genesis 15:1–6; 16:1–5; 17:1–8

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 15:6 (WEB)

“He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.”

Appetizer – Faith Between Promises Gen 15:1–3

¹ After these things Yahweh’s word came to Abram in a vision, saying, ‘Don’t be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward.’ ² Abram said, ‘Lord Yahweh, what will you give me, since I go childless, and he who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?’

³ Abram said, ‘Behold, to me you have given no children; and, behold, one born in my house is my heir.’

Many of us know what it feels like to sit between what God said and what we see. Abram had promises, but no child. Blessing was on his life, but barrenness was in his house. Abram didn’t pretend everything was fine—he told God honestly where his heart was: “What good are all these blessings if I don’t have the one thing You promised?”

Main Course

Bite 1 – Count the Stars, Gen 15:4–6

Behold, Yahweh’s word came to him, saying, ‘This man will not be your heir, but he who will come out of your own body will be your heir.’ Yahweh brought him outside, and said, ‘Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them.’ He said to Abram, ‘So shall your offspring be.’ He believed in Yahweh; and he reckoned it to him for righteousness.

God did not deny Abram’s disappointment; He answered it with a bigger picture. God pulled Abram outside, pointed to the stars, and told him to count the uncountable.

□ **CST: Faith is often proven in the unseen.**

When sight fades, trust sharpens. God asked Abram to believe a promise that his eyes could not yet verify, and heaven called that belief “righteousness.”

Reflection:

What “stars” is God asking you to look at and believe for—even when your current situation says the opposite?

Bite 2 – When We Try to “Help” God, Gen 16:1–4

¹ Now Sarai, Abram’s wife, bore him no children. She had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar.

² Sarai said to Abram, ‘See now, Yahweh has restrained me from bearing. Please go in to my servant. It may be that I will obtain children by her.’ Abram listened to the voice of Sarai.

³ After Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, Sarai took Hagar the Egyptian, her servant, and gave her to Abram her husband to be his wife. ⁴ He went to Hagar, and she conceived. When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.

Sarai and Abram reached a breaking point in the waiting and decided to “help” God. Their plan produced a child—but also tension, comparison, and conflict. Waiting is not always easy but oftentimes required.

When we rush what God promised to perfect, we create situations He never asked us to manage. Grace can redeem our detours, but consequences are still real.

Reflection:

Where are you most tempted to “fix it yourself” instead of waiting on God’s way and God’s time?

Bite 3 – Name Changed, Same Promise, Gen 17:1–5, 7

¹ When Abram was ninety-nine years old, Yahweh appeared to Abram and said to him, ‘I am God Almighty. Walk before me, and be blameless. ² I will make my covenant between me and you, and will multiply you exceedingly.’ ³ Abram fell on his face. God talked with him, saying, ⁴ ‘As for me, behold, my covenant is with you. You will be the father of a multitude of nations.

⁵ Your name will no longer be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ⁷ I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...’

God revisited Abram years later—not to cancel the promise, but to **expand** it and attach it to a covenant. He also changed Abram’s name to Abraham to match what heaven already saw.

He renames us to remind us of who we are becoming, not what we’ve been. Abraham had to learn to answer to a name that sounded like the promise *before* the promise fully showed up.

Reflection:

Is there an area where God is calling you to think, speak, or walk according to His promise—before you see it?



Dessert – Faith Rewarded Through Time, Rom 4:20–21

²⁰ Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn’t waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, ²¹ and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform.

Abraham’s story says:

1. Real faith is honest enough to ask hard questions.
2. Real faith can still stumble, but God picks it back up.
3. God’s timing is perfect, even when it feels “late.”

Reflection:

God doesn’t forget; He fulfills. Abraham’s faith grew stronger over time, even while the promise seemed delayed.

How can you glorify God while you’re still waiting for your “Isaac” to come forth?



To-Go Box

- Faith is not just belief—it’s **endurance** through delay.
- Questioning God honestly doesn’t disqualify you; staying stuck in unbelief does.
- Human shortcuts (like Hagar) may seem faster, but they complicate what God intended to be clean.
- When God reaffirms His promise, He often calls you by a new name or identity that lines up with your future.
- God’s timeline is not denial; it’s divine alignment.

Word Study

- **Abram** – “Exalted Father”
- **Abraham** – “Father of Many Nations”
- **El Shaddai** – “God Almighty,” the all-sufficient One who sustains, provides, and fulfills His promises.

Closing Prayer

“God Almighty, El Shaddai, thank you for being faithful even when my faith feels small. Teach me to wait on Your timing instead of forcing my own solutions. Help me to believe Your promises when I can’t yet see the evidence.

Rename the places in my life that still sound like doubt and align my identity with what You have spoken. Make me fully assured that what You have promised, You are also able to perform. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline

1. Abram’s faith never wavered from the start.
☐ True ☐ False
2. Sarai suggested a human solution to a divine promise.
☐ True ☐ False
3. God changed Abram’s name after he demonstrated obedience.
☐ True ☐ False
4. Hagar’s son was the covenant child.
☐ True ☐ False
5. God’s timing tests faith before fulfilling it.
☐ True ☐ False

(Check the Appendix for answers)

† BM2 — Lesson 4: Chronic Conditions

💧 Victory Through the Blood

📘 **Theme:** Faith That Heals

📖 **Background Text:** Luke 8:42b–48

🔑 **Key Verse:** Luke 8:48 (WEB)

He said to her, ‘**Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.**’

✳️ Author’s Foreword (Intro/Reflection Setup)

“Unclean, Unclean, Unclean!”

In the Jewish law, as depicted in the Pentateuch, many illnesses and conditions could make a person “unclean.” Those labeled unclean could not enter the temple, attend gatherings, or move freely in the community. Some were restricted to their homes or pushed outside normal society. They had to *announce* their condition whenever they came near people.

Imagine living in a world where you had to brandish your “dirty secret” like the old Scarlet Letter—exposed, ashamed, and isolated.

Now imagine carrying that weight not for a few days, but for **twelve years**.

📖 Appetizer – Twelve Years of Pain, Luke 8:42b–43a

“...But as he went, the multitudes pressed against him. ⁴³ A woman who had a flow of blood for twelve years...”

She had spent everything she had on physicians. No one could help her. Her body was weak, her money was gone, and her hope was hanging by a thread.

You’ve tried every YouTube remedy, every social media hack, every doctor, every urgent care, every “miracle” treatment and payment plan... and still no solution. Your resources are drained, and the situation hasn’t changed. That was the woman’s reality.

Imagine having a condition that silently drains you from the inside for over a decade. No clear answers. No lasting relief. Just ongoing pain, shame, and exhaustion.

Reflection:

Have you ever been in a season where you tried *everything* but still had to rely on faith for breakthrough?



Main Course – Faith That Reaches Out



Bite 1 – A Desperate Touch, Luke 8:43b–44

“...who had spent all her living on physicians and could not be healed by any, came behind him and touched the fringe of his cloak. Immediately the flow of her blood stopped.”

If you’ve ever been to a concert of a popular person, you know how thick the crowd is to just get close to the stage. ...She didn’t ask for the microphone, or a front-row seat, or a special audience. She just wanted to get close enough to **touch** Jesus—close enough to reach for the One everyone else was only crowding around.

Well, Jesus was on his way to heal a sick child, when she reached for the hem in a “risk-it-all” move. She wasn’t even supposed to be there.

Faith is often a desperate reach toward Jesus when you have nothing left to lose. Her faith pulled power directly from the Source, and that was the difference between the people who were there just to be there and a woman you refused to be denied wholeness (or a cure).

Thought:

How hard would it be to get close enough to touch a world leader or celebrity? Yet this woman pushed through every barrier—cultural, physical, emotional—to reach the King of kings.

Reflection:

Where in your life do you need that same “pressing through” kind of faith?

Bite 2 – “Who Touched Me?” Luke 8:45–47

⁴⁵ Jesus said, ‘Who touched me?’ When all denied it, Peter and those with him said, ‘Master, the multitudes press and jostle you, and you say, ‘Who touched me?’ ’ ⁴⁶ But Jesus said, ‘Someone did touch me, for I perceived that power has gone out of me.’ ⁴⁷ When the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling, and falling down before him declared to him in the presence of all the people the reason why she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.”

The crowd was pressing against Jesus, but **only one touch drew power**. Proximity is not the same as faith. Many bumped into Him, but only one believed *Him* for change for the issue that ailed her life.

□ CST:

Jesus felt the pull of faith. Power responded not to casual contact but to intentional belief. When the Holy Spirit meets genuine faith, something always shifts.

Reflection:

Recall a time when you had to “touch heaven”—a situation that drove you to seek God’s power above all else. What was happening, and how did that season change you?

Bite 3 – New Name, New Peace, Luke 8:48

He said to her, ‘Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.’

One sentence changed everything—her health, her status, and her identity. She was no longer “unclean woman”; she was **Daughter**.

Author’s Commentary

Her long struggle ended with a single word of affirmation from Jesus. When He calls you Daughter or Son, He doesn’t just fix your issue—He restores your place in the family. The Woman with the Issue of Blood is a story that many can relate to you having a problem and unfortunately making God or prayer your “last resort”, it’s like the dreaded red button under the glass that you do NOT want to push! Push - Pray Until Something Happens - let your faith connect with the Word and power of God. Nobody is saying don’t go to the doctor, but the message is about bringing your faith to the doctor’s office and bring your ISSUES to the altar.

So many of us have suffered in things for a long while, and Jesus is waiting on us to do our part and trust him with it. Break through the doubt, press through the challenges and arrive at the hem of God and the spiritual connection to the healing that was released when our Savior was tied and hung on a tree. Through an long term unclean messed up, messy situation - though her blood was filthy his Blood is cleansing and through it there is victory to everyone who is willing to accept all the benefits of being redeemed, hallelujah!

Dessert – Push Through the Crowd

Sometimes our faith becomes the “last resort,” but God invites us to make it our **first response**. The woman could have stayed home, stayed hidden, stayed hopeless—but she chose to move.

Like her, we are called to:

- Push through doubt.
- Push through fear.
- Push through shame.
- Push through the noise of the crowd...

...until we reach the hem of His garment.

Reflection:

What crowd—voices, opinions, fears, distractions—do you need to push through right now to get closer to Jesus?

To-Go Box

Her blood made her unclean.

His blood made her whole.

Through Christ’s sacrifice:

- We are redeemed, not rejected.
- We are restored, not ruined.
- We are cleansed, not canceled.
- No matter how long the struggle has lasted, **victory is still possible through His blood.**

Carry this with you:

When you reach for Jesus in faith, He always has more healing than you have hurt.